Combat · Saturday · 5 PCs at level 4

Rolls and initiative at the table. Damage is fixed: no damage dice. Write HP in the boxes. 🟡 Draft numbers.

The trap in the binding

MATCHUPS Shears 1 and 2 each take a lane to the article, one from each side. The cart and the swarm go for whoever blocks a lane. Ask the table who's guarding the book.

> R1 · Both shears dive for the page. The cart rolls at the first blocker.
> R2 · The swarm engulfs a blocker. One pair of shears goes down.
> R3 · The second pair drops, and everything else drops with it.

WIN Drop both shears. When the second pair goes down, the rest of the stationery drops where it is.

LOSING? Nobody dies here: a PC at 0 HP is out cold and stable. If it's going badly, the shears finish the page (5 cuts) and everything drops.

CUTS start at 1: 1–2 → 9 pieces · 3–4 → 16 · 5+ → 25. Tally: _____

Archival shears ×2 `AC 14 · HP 12 · fly 30`

1. **A PC between it and the article?** Snip that PC: **+5 to hit, 6 slashing**. No cut this turn.
2. **Nobody in the way?** It flies to the article and cuts. No roll. **Tap +1 cut.**

It never goes after anyone who isn't in its way.

DROPS It snaps shut and clatters to the floor.

1 ☐ 2 ☐

Swarm of index cards `AC 12 · HP 22 · fly 30`

1. Moves onto the PC blocking a shears lane (or the nearest PC).
2. Paper cuts: **+5 to hit, 7 slashing**.

Fire does double.

DROPS The cards settle like snow and lie still.

HP ☐

The book cart `AC 14 · HP 33 · 30`

1. Rolls at the PC blocking a shears lane (or the nearest PC).
2. Ram: **+5 to hit, 9 bludgeoning**, and that PC is pushed 10 ft, out of the lane.

DROPS A wheel comes off; it tips over and spills its books.

HP ☐

First contact — a pressure scene, not a fight

WIN Nobody wins. They get grabbed, shoved and scared, and nobody gets hurt.

ENDS When Orlok says one word: after a round or two, or the moment it stops being fun.

LOSING? They can't lose. No Bite, no damage, nobody drops.

Dracula `AC 16 · HP — · 40, climbs walls`

1. Swoops 40 ft at whoever failed Stealth and grabs them: **DC 15 Str or Dex save** or grappled. Escaping takes their action and a **DC 15** Athletics or Acrobatics check.
2. **Already holding someone?** Shoves them 10 ft toward the others, or pins them and looms.
3. **Orlok speaks?** Lets go and steps back. Done.

No Bite. No damage. Nobody drops. No HP to track: if they hit him, he laughs.

DROPS He doesn't. Orlok's one word ends it.

ALSO IN THE HALL

Orlok · Doesn't act. When you're ready to end it: one word.

Edward · Doesn't act. Watches Bix.

The botched summoning

MATCHUPS The summoning takes whoever stands between it and the sealed door. Fragments 1 and 2 go for the PCs hitting it; fragments 3 and 4 go for the back line.

> R1 · The fragments swarm. It lurches for the door.
> R2 · It claws whoever is in its way. The fragments start crumbling.
> R3 · Under half: the Unfinished Word.
> R4 · It drops. The monitor line.

WIN Drop the summoning. The fragments crumble with it.

LOSING? It never attacks a PC at 0 HP: it wants the door. If two PCs are down, it tears through the wall toward the sealed door and comes apart on the threshold. Read the kill line anyway.

The botched summoning `AC 13 · HP 85 · 30`

1. Lurches toward the sealed door down the hall. It can't leave the room.
2. Claws twice at the nearest PC: **+6 to hit, 9 slashing** each.
3. **Once, the first time it's under 43 HP:** Unfinished Word. Every PC within 15 ft makes a **DC 13 Wis save**: 13 psychic, half on a save.

Never attacks a PC at 0 HP.

DROPS Read the monitor line, fire the AIM chime, then kill all sound.

HP ☐

Ritual fragments ×4 `AC 12 · HP 7 · 30`

1. Goes for whoever is hitting the summoning (or the nearest PC).
2. Grab: **+4 to hit, 5 necrotic**.

DROPS Crumbles to chalk dust.

1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐

Combat · Sunday · 5 PCs at level 5

Rolls and initiative at the table. Damage is fixed: no damage dice. Write HP in the boxes. 🟡 Draft numbers.

The circle stirs — reserve, don't plan on it

MATCHUPS The remnant takes the nearest PC. Fragments 1–4 split across the rest.

> R1 · The fragments swarm. The remnant claws the nearest PC.
> R2 · The fragments crumble. Under half: the Unfinished Word.
> R3 · It drops.

WIN Drop the remnant. The fragments crumble with it.

LOSING? Same as last night: it never attacks a PC at 0 HP. If two PCs are down, it smears apart on its own.

The remnant — **AC 14 · HP 100 · 30**

1. Moves to the nearest PC. It can't leave the room.
2. Claws twice: **+7 to hit, 11 slashing** each.
3. **Once, the first time it's under 50 HP:** Unfinished Word. Every PC within 15 ft makes a **DC 14 Wis save**: 18 psychic, half on a save.

Never attacks a PC at 0 HP.

DROPS Chalk dust. The circle is just a drawing now.

HP ☐

Ritual fragments ×4 — **AC 12 · HP 10 · 30**

1. Goes for the nearest PC.
2. Grab: **+5 to hit, 6 necrotic**.

DROPS Crumbles to chalk dust.

1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐

The developer

ENEMY RIGHT NOW Ostrander and his thugs. Poe Boy is on the decks, on the mic, not in this fight. If a PC goes for him, the charmed crowd is in the way and Ostrander's men are on them.

MATCHUPS The vampires take thugs 4–6 on the far side of the ballroom. The party faces Ostrander and thugs 1–3 at the breach. Poe Boy stays up on the decks, on the mic; he isn't in this fight.

> R1 · Thugs 1–3 rush the party. Ostrander hangs back by the door, barking orders, and Holds whoever hits him. End of round: a vampire kills thug 4.
> R2 · Thugs 1–3 start dropping. End of round: the vampires kill thugs 5 and 6.
> R3 · Ostrander is exposed: nobody left between him and the party.
> R4 · He goes down. Stop. Silence.

ALLIES The vampires kill thug 4 at the end of round 1, and thugs 5 and 6 at the end of round 2. Narrate it, no rolls. Then they hold the room and leave Ostrander to the party.

WIN Drop Ostrander. The party has to do it, not the vampires.

LOSING? If two PCs are down: Orlok and Dracula pin him to the wall. He loses his turns, and the next hit from a PC kills him.

W. Ostrander — **AC 15 · HP 100 · 30**

1. **A PC hit him since his last turn?** Hold that PC: **DC 15 Wis save** or they lose their next turn, frozen.
2. Surveyor's rod at the nearest PC: **+6 to hit, 10 bludgeoning**.
3. Steps back behind his crew.

The first 25 damage is his ward cracking: narrate it, it's in the 100. No damage spells. Doesn't swing at a PC who's down.

DROPS He's dead. Stop. Silence. Any thug still standing drops his crowbar and backs against the wall. Then the booth.

HP ☐

Thugs ×6 — **AC 12 · HP 16 · 30**

1. **A PC on Ostrander?** Gets between them. Otherwise moves to the nearest PC.
2. Crowbar: **+4 to hit, 8 bludgeoning**.

Doesn't swing at a PC who's down.

DROPS Dead. A hard hat rolls across the floor.

1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5 ☐ 6 ☐

ALSO

Angelique · What she does at the finale is still open. **If she's with the party:** 8 piercing on a thug, no roll.

The booth

ENEMY RIGHT NOW Poe Boy and Lil Stinky. Get the USB to the decks; don't kill him. The vampires are with the party, and the remaining thugs have dropped their crowbars. When the recording plays there's no enemy: the fight's over.

MATCHUPS Lil Stinky holds the decks; Poe Boy stays behind them, on the mic. Orlok goes for Stinky, Dracula shadows whoever holds the USB, Edward hangs back to pull PCs clear. The party's job: get the USB to the decks and get Stinky off them.

> R1 · The USB is on the move. Poe Boy Commands its holder: “Drop.”
> R2 · The party reaches the decks. Stinky swings at the holder and smokes a vampire (Russ's heal).
> R3 · Stinky gets moved or drops. Someone plugs in.
> R4 · The recording plays. Stinky sits down. The room turns.

ALLIES One vampire a round, in turn, after everyone: Orlok grips Stinky, Dracula carries the USB holder toward the decks, Edward pulls a PC clear. Narrate it, no rolls.

WIN A PC at the decks plugs the USB in (their action). Then narrate the recording.

LOSING? It can't be lost. If it drags past round 4, Dracula snatches the drive and lands it in a PC's hand at the decks.

DJ Poe Boy — **AC 15 · HP 120 · 30**

1. Command, one word, **DC 15 Wis save**. The PC holding the USB: “Drop.” (it lands at their feet). Nobody holding it: the PC nearest the decks, “Flee.” (they spend their next move running from him).
2. Mic stand at anyone next to him: **+4 to hit, 4 bludgeoning**. Pathetic on purpose.

Can't drop below 1 HP until the recording plays: at 1 he's on his knees behind the decks, still on the mic. +3 on his saves while Stinky is within 10 ft.

DROPS He doesn't drop. Once the recording plays, his Command stops landing, the room boos and Dracula takes the mic. The fight runs into the early morning; cut to the driveway at sunrise.

HP ☐

Lil Stinky — **AC 18 · HP 60 · 30**

1. Back to the decks, next to Poe Boy.
2. Longsword twice: **+5 to hit, 8 radiant** each. The PC holding the USB if he can reach them, otherwise the nearest vampire.

Nobody can plug in while he's standing at the decks. Shove him, grapple him, move him with a spell or a vampire, or drop him, then plug in. A vampire he hits smokes and staggers: that's Russ's heal for badge req 3.

DROPS At 0 HP he's on one knee, sword down: out of the fight, awake, and still hears the recording. When it plays, his oath breaks, no save. He sits down.

HP ☐

ALSO

Angelique · What she does at the finale is still open. **If she's with the party:** 8 piercing on Stinky, no roll, every round.

They don't drop and have no HP to track.